



Philips TAB8967 soundbar

Great sound, matching build, limited yet useful features make for a great deal

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Soundbars are interesting. On one hand, we have people who wonder who buys them anymore, and on the other, we have the ones who are willing to spend a chunk of their hard-earned money on a soundbar that will bring the theatres to their homes. Having spoken to industry experts over the last year and a half, it is very clear that the number of people belonging to the second section is in plenty. Thus, brands have been scrambling to get their share of the market. The mid-range segment of the market, with soundbars between 30-70K seems to be the one in focus as there are plenty of brands, including Philips, whose soundbar I will be talking about today, that are filling in all the gaps in the pricing.

Philips released their Philips TAB8967 soundbar (please give it simpler names 😊), earlier this year, and I

got a chance to spend some time with it, here at the Digit Test Centre. Priced at ₹44,990 at the time of writing, the soundbar made an interesting case for itself. It pleased me with its looks and sound, but there were some gripes that I had with it that I believe could be fixed by the brand in the next iteration. As it is with any product, I did the due diligence to put it through its paces. I watched movies, played my favourite tunes, and played a few games as well, and here's what I found out –

Connectivity

- USB playback - Yes
- HDMI IN x 1
- HDMI Out (eARC/ARC) x 1
- EasyLink (HDMI-CEC) - Yes
- HDMI content protection - HDCP 1.4/2.3
- Wireless connection - Bluetooth 5.0
- Optical input x 1
- AUX in
- WiFi - IEEE 802.11 a/b/g/n/ac | 2.4GHz/5GHz

- Works with Apple Airplay 2
- Built-in Chromecast
- Works with Ok Google

Build, design, and features

The design of the Philips TAB8967 soundbar is something that immediately stood out to me once I pulled it out of the box. Most manufacturers these days go for a black finish on their bar with rounded corners and a design that has now been templated to a certain extent. But Philips has gone out of their way to give this soundbar a standout look with the sharp angular design on the soundbar and a silver finish. Now, depending on your taste, this might be something that you would either love or hate. But for me, it was a breath of fresh air. The same colour finish continues on the subwoofer and the satellite speakers as well. The subwoofer has a more squared-off design though, with a fabric mesh covering the side cavity.

As for the materials used, Philips has gone with a metallic face plate for the soundbar, with the rest of the body being polycarbonate. This, again, is something that I love! There is a nice heft in every part of the setup that you get - the subwoofer and the soundbar itself. The feet on the soundbar and the subwoofer also do their job well in reducing the rumble when you are playing back audio at high volumes. If you are on a slightly slippery surface, like a tiled floor, there is some amount of rumble that can be felt in the subwoofer. However, for the most part, you should be fine and not worried about the bar falling off your TV rack.

In terms of the features, there is not a whole lot to talk about. Around the ₹50K mark, you will get a certain number of features on the bar, but don't expect brands to include the best of the best there is in the market at this price. Same is the case with the Philips TAB8967. The soundbar comes packed with basic features like connectivity to voice assistants like Siri and Google Assistant, which will be great for all the fans of home automa-